

THE UNAPOLOGETIC LEADER · A DIAGNOSTIC
KIT

What Am I *Carrying?*

A 20-question diagnostic to find what
isn't yours to hold — and what to set
down first.

BY AMANDA FRIEDT · THEUNAPOLOGETICLEADER.COM

HOW TO USE THIS

Two questions, honestly answered.

Underneath all the exhaustion is one question with two halves: *what belongs to me — and what doesn't?* Most high-capacity people have never been asked to sort it, so they carry all of it.

You'll rate twenty statements across five domains, score each, and find your heaviest. Then you'll sort what's yours from what isn't, get the scripts to set the rest down, and a one-week plan to do it. Answer fast — your first instinct is the true one.

The whole thing in one line

Just because you can carry it doesn't mean it's yours to carry.

Responsibility

Where you've become the default fixer.

Rate each 0 (never) to 3 (almost always).

When something breaks and no one's handling it, I step in — even when it isn't mine. 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐

People bring me problems that belong to someone else, and I solve them. 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐

If I don't stay on top of it, I assume it'll fall apart. 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐

I'm the one who remembers, coordinates, and follows up so others don't have to. 0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐

Domain A total: _____ / 12

Emotional labor

Where you carry other people's feelings.

Rate each 0 (never) to 3 (almost always).

I manage how the people around me feel — smoothing, soothing, anticipating.	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
--	---

I feel responsible when someone else is upset, even if I didn't cause it.	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
--	---

I'm the person others vent to, and I hold it long after they've let it go.	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
---	---

I shrink my own reaction so I don't add to the room's weight.	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
--	---

Domain B total: _____ / 12

Control

Where care has tipped into control.

Rate each 0 (never) to 3 (almost always).

I redo or closely check others' work because it's easier than trusting it.	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
--	---

Delegating feels like a risk, so I keep the load.	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
---	---

I step in before someone can struggle, even when struggling would help them.	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
--	---

Things mostly work when I'm in the room — and wobble when I'm not.	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
--	---

Domain C total: _____ / 12

Identity

Where your worth got fused to your output.

Rate each 0 (never) to 3 (almost always).

My sense of being okay rises and falls with how much I accomplished.	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
--	---

Resting makes me anxious, like I haven't earned the stillness.	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
--	---

If I weren't the capable one, I'm not sure what I'd be to people.	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
---	---

I say yes to protect how others see me, not because I have capacity.	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
--	---

Domain D total: _____ / 12

Depletion

Where the cost is already showing.

Rate each 0 (never) to 3 (almost always).

I'm tired in a way that sleep doesn't fix.	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
--	---

I can't always tell where I end and my responsibilities begin.	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
--	---

I've stopped noticing what I want, because I'm tracking what everyone needs.	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
--	---

I feel most alone in the rooms that depend on me most.	0 ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐
--	---

Domain E total: _____ / 12

NOW SCORE IT

Add up what you're holding.

Total your five domains. Your highest isn't a verdict — it's a doorway. It tells you where the weight is, and where setting one thing down frees the most.

YOUR SCORE

What the numbers mean.

Domain A ___ B ___ C ___ D ___ E ___ **Total** ___ / 60

0-20 • Holding steady

You carry some weight that isn't yours, but you can still feel your edges. Protect that — use the scripts before the load grows.

21-40 • Over-functioning

You've become responsible for more than is yours, and it's costing you. Your highest domain is where to start. Set one thing down this week.

41-60 • Carrying the room

You've become the infrastructure everything stands on, and the depletion is real. This isn't a discipline problem. Start with the sort, and be ruthless about the “not mine” column.

THE SORT

Mine, and not mine.

Take what surfaced and put it where it belongs. Capable of holding it is not the same as it's yours.

Mine

Not mine

THE SCRIPTS

A boundary, said as a full sentence.

You don't owe a thesis. A boundary said as one clean sentence is a complete act of respect — for them and for you.

“I can't take that on.”

“That doesn't work for me.”

“I'm not available for that — but here's who might be.”

“I hear how hard this is. I trust you to handle it.”

“I'm going to let you take the lead on this one.”

“I care about this. I'm not going to carry it for you.”

“Let me think about it” — then actually decide, instead of defaulting to yes.

“That's yours to choose. I'll support the choice you make.”

THE PLAN

Set one thing down this week.

The one thing I'm setting down:

Who it actually belongs to:

The sentence I'll use:

What I'll do with the space it frees:

THE POINT OF ALL OF IT

You don't have to hold everything together.

You have to place yourself where your gifts do the most good, and let everything else find its own footing. That's not the absence of care. It's the most honest form of it.

Keep this kit close. When your arms start to fill again — and they will — you already know the two questions to ask.

*Unapologetically,
Amanda*